

Reading Comprehension – Non-Fiction

Name:

Date:

ACARA V9.0 — AC9E3LY03: Identify the audience and purpose of informative texts through their use of language features.

Learning Intention: I am learning to read a non-fiction text and find key facts and information.**Key Idea:** Non-fiction texts give **true information**. Good readers look for **facts, key words**, and important details as they read.**Warm-Up:** Before reading, look at the title. What do you already know about Australian animals?

A. Read the Text

Amazing Australian Animals

Australia is home to many unique animals found nowhere else in the world. The koala is a marsupial that spends most of its life sleeping in eucalyptus trees, up to 20 hours a day! It only eats eucalyptus leaves, which are tough and low in nutrients, so koalas need lots of rest to save energy.

Another famous Australian animal is the platypus. It is one of only a few mammals that lay eggs. The platypus has a duck-like bill, webbed feet, and lives near rivers and streams. It uses its bill to sense the electric signals of small animals hiding in the mud.

Kangaroos are also well known. They use their strong back legs and long tail to hop instead of walk. A baby kangaroo, called a joey, stays safe inside its mother's pouch for several months after it is born.

B. Literal Questions

1. How many hours a day does a koala sleep?

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2. What is a baby kangaroo called?

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C. Find the Facts

1. What does a platypus use its bill for?

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2. Name one thing that makes the platypus unusual for a mammal.

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D. Key Vocabulary

Match the word to its meaning.

marsupial joey webbed

___ a baby kangaroo

___ an animal that carries its young in a pouch

___ feet with skin between the toes

Answer Guide & Extension Activities

Suggested Answers – B & C

B. 1. Up to 20 hours. 2. A joey.

C. 1. To sense the electric signals of small animals in the mud. 2. It lays eggs.

Suggested Answers – D

joey – a baby kangaroo marsupial – carries young in a pouch
webbed – feet with skin between the toes

High Five Stars – Self Assessment

★ I read for key facts

★ I answered literal questions

★ I found facts in the text

★ I matched key vocabulary

Extension Activity

Choose one animal from the text and write two more facts about it using a book or the internet with an adult's help.

Parent/Teacher Tip

Non-fiction texts can be read out of order. Try letting your child choose which paragraph to read first based on what interests them most.

Reflection

Which Australian animal from the text did you find the most interesting, and why?
